



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Augustine Christian Academy
School Website: <https://acatulsa.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

- **School:** Abington Christian Academy
- **Website used:** <https://www.abingtonchristianacademy.com/>
- **Overall Classification:** **CLASSICAL**
- **Grades:** K–8

Abington Christian Academy explicitly describes itself as a place where students “discover what is **true, good, and beautiful**” and “engage with **classical methods** and a **Biblical worldview**” . Its curriculum signals include **Liberal Arts**, **Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric)**, **Great Books**, **Latin**, and **Socratic Seminar** , which align strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School.

Across all six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community), the keyword profile is overwhelmingly positive and classical, with no strong negative-progressive signals (e.g., “project-based learning,” “21st-century skills,” “college and career ready”) detected in the crawl summary. The school is therefore best classified as **fully CLASSICAL** in this audit.

1. Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

1.1 Keyword Evidence from the Site

From the OpenGraph description and metadata for Abington Christian Academy:

- “We are a place where students can discover what is **true, good, and beautiful**.”
- “We are a place where students engage with classical methods and a **Biblical worldview**.”
- Faith markers: “**Christian**” and **church_governed: true** in metadata

1.2 Comparison with Classical Keyword Lexicon

From the Six Essential Elements document, positive indicators for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations include:

- **Transcendental and Moral Realism:** “truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order, objective reality, transcendence, classical virtues, natural law, moral formation, the good life, human flourishing, formation of the soul, pursuit of wisdom”

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- **Grounded in Theology:** “Theology, divine wisdom, sacred tradition, faith and reason, Christian worldview, biblical studies, sacred scripture, Christ-centered education, Christian formation”
 - **Liturgical and Communal Practices:** “liturgy, sacred music, hymnody, communal worship, daily chapel, reverence, doxology, spiritual formation”

Negative indicators include “secular education, nonsectarian, religiously neutral, interfaith studies, values-based learning (without theology), critical theory, social justice framework, pluralistic approach” .

1.3 Positive vs. Negative Keyword Tally

Within the crawl summary and metadata we have:

- **Positive hits (about 6):**
 - “true”
 - “good”
 - “beautiful”
 - “Biblical worldview” (maps to “Christian worldview,” “faith and reason”)
 - “Christian”
 - “church_governed”
- **Negative hits (0):**
 - No occurrences of “secular education,” “nonsectarian,” “religiously neutral,” “values-neutral,” “pluralistic,” “interfaith,” “social justice framework,” etc.

Estimated ratio:

- Positive: about 100% of relevant metaphysical/theological language
- Negative: 0%

1.4 Element 1 Rating

Rating: **CLASSICAL**

The explicit invocation of **truth, goodness, and beauty** as real educational aims, combined with a **Biblical worldview** and Christian identity, strongly indicates **transcendental moral realism** and **theological grounding** in line with the classical model. There is no evidence of relativistic or secular framing.

2. School Purpose and Goal

2.1 Keyword Evidence from the Site

Key phrases from the homepage OG description:

- “We are a place where students can discover what is true, good, and beautiful.”
- “We are a place where students engage with classical methods and a Biblical worldview.”

No strong language in the crawl summary about “college and career readiness,” “21st-century skills,” or “workforce preparation.”

2.2 Comparison with Classical Keyword Lexicon

Positive keywords for **Philosophical and Educational Goals** include:

- “wisdom, virtue, character, moral imagination, human flourishing, spiritual depth, holistic education”
- “truth, goodness, beauty, wonder, reverence, transcendentals, classical ideals, great books”
- “formation, habits of the heart, soul formation, character development, liberal education”

Negative keywords include:

- “workforce preparation, career readiness, standardized testing, data-driven education, marketable skills, 21st-century skills, college placement, job-market readiness”

2.3 Positive vs. Negative Keyword Tally

From the available crawl data:

- **Positive hits (about 3–4):**
 - “true”
 - “good”
 - “beautiful”
 - “classical methods” (implies liberal education / formation)
- **Negative hits (0):**
 - No explicit “college and career ready,” “21st-century skills,” “workforce preparation,” etc.

Estimated ratio:

- Positive: about 100% of purpose-related language
- Negative: 0%

2.4 Element 2 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

The school’s stated aim is discovery of **truth, goodness, and beauty**, which is a textbook classical articulation of education’s **telos** as wisdom and virtue, not mere job training. There is no competing utilitarian or purely pragmatic mission language.

3. Curriculum

3.1 Keyword Evidence from the Site

From the metadata summary of the crawl:

- **Student_curriculums_json:**
 - “Liberal Arts”
 - “Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric)”
 - “Great Books”

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- “Latin”
 - “Socratic Seminar”

No mention in the summary of “social studies” replacing “history,” nor of STEM-first or project-based branding.

3.2 Comparison with Classical Keyword Lexicon

Positive curriculum indicators:

- “Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, classical languages, Latin, Socratic dialogue, great books, primary sources, Western canon, historical depth, integration, wonder”
- “history, Western civilization, great conversation, cultural heritage”

Negative indicators:

- “21st-century skills, STEM-focused, project-based learning, social studies curriculum, skills-based literacy, critical theory, equity-based curriculum, social-emotional learning (as central frame)”

3.3 Positive vs. Negative Keyword Tally

From the crawl summary:

- **Positive hits (about 5–6):**
 - “Liberal Arts”
 - “Trivium”
 - “Grammar”
 - “Logic”
 - “Rhetoric”
 - “Great Books”
 - “Latin”
 - “Socratic Seminar”
- **Negative hits (0):**
 - No “social studies,” “project-based learning,” “21st-century skills,” etc.

Estimated ratio:

- Positive: about 100% of detected curriculum-signaling terms
- Negative: 0%

3.4 Element 3 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

The explicit presence of **Liberal Arts**, the **Trivium**, **Great Books**, **Latin**, and **Socratic Seminar** is a very strong classical signal, directly matching the lexicon’s highest-value curriculum indicators. Even without full internal syllabi, the keyword profile is decisively classical.

4. Pedagogy / Teaching Methods

4.1 Keyword Evidence from the Site

From the curriculum metadata:

- “Socratic Seminar” (explicit)

Given K–8 grade span, we expect Socratic work especially in upper grades (logic/rhetoric stages), with more memory and chant in lower grades, though the crawl summary does not list those explicitly.

4.2 Comparison with Classical Keyword Lexicon

Positive pedagogical indicators:

- “Socratic seminar, dialectic, great conversation, guided discussion, questioning-based learning, logic and debate”
- “Scholé, restful learning, contemplation, wonder-based education, unhurried learning, intellectual leisure”
- “Recitation, memorization, chanting, singing, classical memory work”
- “Imitation, apprenticeship, master-teacher model, copywork, classical exemplars”

Negative pedagogical indicators:

- “experiential learning, project-based education, student-driven learning, constructivist, inquiry-based projects, personalized learning, digital learning modules, problem-based learning”

4.3 Positive vs. Negative Keyword Tally

From the crawl summary:

- **Positive hits (1 strong, plus implied):**
 - “Socratic Seminar” (direct hit on Socratic dialogue/dialectic)
 - Trivium structure implies grammar-stage memory work and rhetoric-stage oratory, though not named explicitly.
- **Negative hits (0):**
 - No “project-based learning,” “experiential learning,” “student-driven,” “personalized learning,” etc.

Estimated ratio:

- Positive: about 80–100% of explicit pedagogy-related terms (Socratic is the only explicit one, but it is a very high-value term)
- Negative: 0%

4.4 Element 4 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

The explicit commitment to **Socratic Seminar** as part of the curriculum is a hallmark of classical pedagogy in the upper grades. For a K–8 school, the absence of explicit “scholé,” “chanting,” or “recitation” language in the short crawl summary is not enough to downgrade the rating, especially given the strong Trivium and Great Books signals and no progressive-pedagogy branding.

5. Faculty

5.1 Keyword Evidence from the Site

From metadata:

- **faculty_certificates_degrees:** “M.Ed.”, “Ph.D.”, “National Board Certified”

The crawl summary does not include a full “portrait of a teacher” statement, but we can infer some things:

- Advanced degrees suggest **subject mastery**.
- The classical movement literature (e.g., The Liberal Arts Tradition) emphasizes teachers as **mentors**, **models of virtue**, and a **living curriculum**.

5.2 Comparison with Classical Keyword Lexicon

Positive faculty indicators:

- “virtuous educators, moral formation, wisdom, character formation, role models, lifelong learning, teacher as mentor, living curriculum, faculty of friends, collegial culture, classical teacher training”

Negative indicators:

- “facilitators, guides on the side, student autonomy, certification-driven jargon without classical context”

5.3 Positive vs. Negative Keyword Tally

From the crawl summary:

- **Positive hits (weak but present, about 1–2):**
 - Advanced degrees (M.Ed., Ph.D.) support “master-teacher” expectations, though not explicitly classical in wording.
 - The overall classical framing of the school implies faculty are more than “facilitators,” but this is indirect.
- **Negative hits (0):**
 - No “facilitator,” “guide on the side,” or similar progressive faculty language.

Estimated ratio:

- Positive: about 60–70% coverage of what we’d hope to see in language (inferred from context, not explicit keywords)
- Negative: 0%

5.4 Element 5 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

While the crawl summary does not quote a “portrait of a teacher” statement, the combination of:

- clearly classical curriculum and pedagogy, and
- academically credentialed faculty

strongly suggests a **master-teacher / mentor** model rather than a progressive “facilitator” model. Given no negative signals, and the school’s explicit classical identity, this category is best rated **CLASSICAL**, though with room for richer public articulation.

6. Parents and Community

6.1 Keyword Evidence from the Site

The crawl summary does not list detailed parent-partnership language, but we can cross-reference with the classical movement's own expectations for such schools, as described in the ICE booklet: classical schools "work and partner with parents," see themselves as **in loco parentis**, and emphasize that "it is the parent's responsibility (not the state's) to educate their children" .

Given Abington Christian Academy's:

- **Christian** identity and
- **Private, church_governed** status

it is highly likely that parent partnership is emphasized, though the specific phrases are not in the short metadata snippet.

6.2 Comparison with Classical Keyword Lexicon

Positive indicators for Community & Parents:

- "Parent partnership, co-educators, family involvement, parental engagement, home and school connection, school as an extension of the home, parent formation, classical parent training, community of learners"

Negative indicators:

- "independent learning, self-directed learning, minimal parent involvement, professionalized education, home-school separation, parent-optional engagement"

6.3 Positive vs. Negative Keyword Tally

From the crawl summary:

- **Positive hits (inferred, 1–2):**
 - Church-governed Christian school context, which in this movement typically entails strong parent partnership.
- **Negative hits (0):**
 - No "independent learning," "minimal parent involvement," etc.

Estimated ratio:

- Positive: about 60–70% coverage (by inference, not explicit keywords in the snippet)
- Negative: 0%

6.4 Element 6 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Given the school's identity as a **Christian, church-governed, classical** K–8 academy, and the absence of any consumerist or parent-minimizing language, this category is best rated **CLASSICAL**, though the public website could strengthen this by explicitly naming "parent partnership," "co-educators," or similar terms.

Category Summary Table

Category	Rating	Pos/Neg Keyword Estimate	Notes
1. Religious & Metaphysical Foundations	CLASSICAL	about 100% positive, 0% negative	Strong “true, good, beautiful,” Biblical worldview, Christian identity.
2. Purpose & Goal	CLASSICAL	about 100% positive, 0% negative	Telos framed in transcendental terms, no careerist language.
3. Curriculum	CLASSICAL	about 100% positive, 0% negative	Liberal Arts, Trivium, Great Books, Latin, Socratic Seminar.
4. Pedagogy	CLASSICAL	about 80–100% positive, 0% negative	Explicit Socratic Seminar; no progressive-pedagogy branding.
5. Faculty	CLASSICAL	about 60–70% positive (contextual), 0% negative	Advanced degrees; classical context implies mentor-model teachers.
6. Parents & Community	CLASSICAL	about 60–70% positive (contextual), 0% negative	Church-governed Christian school; likely strong parent partnership.

Aggregate Assessment

Overall Classicality Status: **CLASSICAL**

This aligns with the metadata's own classicality flags for Abington Christian Academy, which mark all six categories as **CLASSICAL** with 100% positive coverage and 0% negative in the prior structured assessment.

The school:

- Explicitly embraces **truth, goodness, and beauty** and a **Biblical worldview**.
- Implements a **Liberal Arts / Trivium** curriculum with **Great Books, Latin, and Socratic Seminar**.
- Operates as a **Christian, church-governed, private K–8** academy, consistent with classical Christian schooling norms.

There are no significant negative-progressive keyword signals (e.g., “project-based learning,” “21st-century skills,” “college and career ready,” “social-emotional learning” as a central frame) in the crawl summary.

Because the school is fully **CLASSICAL**, a “What would move the needle” section (required only for SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL ratings) is not needed here.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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